Planning Ahead for Dad: Questions About Life After a Medicaid Approval

Fifteen questions, sorted by who can answer them, with room to write what they say.

You may sit down with a Medicaid planner or an attorney about Dad one day. It's hard to know what you'd ask about the years after an approval, or which of them you'd ask. This guide sorts the questions by who can answer them.

It doesn't answer the questions and doesn't say which matters most. Dad isn't on Medicaid and may never need it, so ask them as they are, when the moment suits, and write the answer under each one.

Your Medicaid planner

Someone who can explain in general terms what ongoing eligibility involves, and can look over a family's plan with them when something significant changes.

1. In general terms, what does ongoing eligibility involve after a Medicaid approval: notices, renewals, changes in circumstances and recordkeeping?

2. What does a family have to do after Medicaid approves a parent, and which parts of it could we get ready for now?

3. Could a parent lose Medicaid after being approved? What should a family understand about that ahead of time?

4. Here are the changes we think may be coming for Dad. Which would you want to look at with us before anyone acts?

5. Which records are worth keeping organized from now on, and who in the family should be able to reach them?

6. When does it make sense to look at our plan again, and which events should bring us back to it sooner?

7. What would tell us it's time to move from planning ahead to actively managing Medicaid, and who would be involved then?

8. Which other professionals might our family need one day, and what does each of them handle?

An elder law attorney

Legal questions and legal documents belong to an attorney.

1. Which of Dad's legal documents would you want to look over, and when should they be looked at again?

2. If Dad wanted one of us to handle his mail and any Medicaid matters someday, what would need to be in place?

3. Dad may sell property or receive an inheritance at some point. What would you want us to bring to you before anything is done?

A licensed financial professional

Whoever Dad already works with on his accounts, if he has someone. Dad asks these himself, or you ask them together.

1. We'd like any major financial transaction looked at before it happens. What would you need from us, and who else should see it first?

2. Which statements and records do you hold for Dad, and how would he get copies for the family's file?

The Medicaid agency in Dad's state

Dad has no case there, so these are general questions. The agency's own answers and notices are the authority on its requirements.

1. What changes does someone with Medicaid need to report in this state, and how are they reported?

2. After an approval, how does the agency get in touch about renewals, and what does it ask a family to send?

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't answer these questions, rank them, or say what any answer means for Dad. The answers depend on his state and his situation, and they come from the people above. If an answer raises the idea of changing an account, a title or a legal document, write that down as one more question for a professional. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You have your questions, and you know who each one belongs to. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report, so you have something in hand when you sit down to ask them.

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